



NOTICE TO BENEFICIARY/CLAIMANT REGARDING THE INFORMATION AND EVIDENCE NEEDED TO SUPPORT A CLAIM FOR ADDITIONAL BENEFITS FOR A DEPENDENT OR TO REMOVE A DEPENDENT FROM AN AWARD

Use this form and the attached application to:

- submit a claim for additional benefits for a dependent, or
- request removal of a dependent from your award.

The table below identifies the types of dependents for whom VA beneficiaries may be entitled to additional benefits.

If you are a ...	Then you may be entitled to additional benefits for ...
veteran entitled to disability compensation who has a combined disability rating of at least 30 percent	• a spouse, • children under age 18, • children that are between the ages of 18 and 23 who are attending school, • children over age 18 that are permanently incapable of self-support, and/or • dependent parents.
veteran entitled to Veterans Pension	• a spouse, • children under age 18, • children that are between the ages of 18 and 23 who are attending school, and/or • children over age 18 that are permanently incapable of self-support
surviving spouse entitled to survivors benefits	• children under age 18, • children that are between the ages of 18 and 23 who are attending school, and/or • children over age 18 that are permanently incapable of self-support. Exception: A surviving spouse entitled to Dependency and Indemnity Compensation (DIC) is not entitled to additional benefits for children over age 18 that receive DIC in his/her own right.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

The table below provides a guide to the instructions and the application. The completion of certain sections of this application are required. Be aware that you ***must*** complete **Section I - Veteran/Claimant's Identification Information** and **Section X - Beneficiary/Claimant's Certification and Signature**. If these sections are not complete, we will ***not*** be able to process your claim for additional benefits for dependents. Otherwise, complete the remaining sections that apply to you.

If you are ...	Instructions	Application
claiming additional benefits for a spouse	Pages 3 and 4	Pages 8 and 9
claiming additional benefits for a child	Pages 4 - 5	Pages 10 and 11
reporting a divorce	Page 5	Page 12
reporting that a stepchild is no longer a member of your household	Page 6	Page 12 and 13
reporting the death of a • spouse • child • dependent parent	Page 5 Page 6 Page 6	Page 13
reporting the marriage of a child	Page 6	Page 13
reporting that a schoolchild over 18 has stopped attending school	Page 6	Page 13
claiming additional benefits for more than four children		Addendum - Page 15

CIRCUMSTANCES THAT REQUIRE ADDITIONAL FORMS

Under certain circumstances, other forms in addition to VA Form 21-686c, *Application Request to Add and/or Remove Dependents*, must be provided when claiming additional benefits for a dependent. The table below describes those circumstances. All VA forms are available at www.va.gov/vaforms.

If ...	Then submit ...
you are seeking additional benefits for a child or children who are between the ages of 18 and 23 who are attending school	VA Form 21-674, <i>Request for Approval of School Attendance</i> . Note: Submit VA Form 21-686c in addition to VA Form 21-674 only if you have never received additional benefits for the child or children.
- you are entitled to Veterans Pension (instead of disability compensation based on service-connected disabilities), and - you are seeking additional benefits for a spouse only	VA Form 21P-0516-1, <i>Improved Pension Eligibility Verification Report (Veteran With No Children)</i> , in addition to VA Form 21-686c.
- you are entitled to Veterans Pension - you are seeking additional benefits for a child or children (with or without a spouse), and - the child or children are under the age of 23 or permanently incapable of self-support	VA Form 21P-0517-1, <i>Improved Pension Eligibility Verification Report (Veteran With Children)</i> , in addition to VA Form 21-686c.
- you are entitled to Survivors Pension, (instead of DIC based on a veteran's service-connected death) and - you are seeking additional benefits for a child or children that are either under the age of 23 or permanently incapable of self-support.	VA Form 21P-0519s-1, <i>Improved Pension Eligibility Verification Report (Surviving Spouse With Children)</i> , in addition to VA Form 21-686c.
- you are a veteran entitled to disability compensation (based on service-connected disabilities), and - you are seeking additional benefits for a dependent parent or parents.	VA Form 21P-509, <i>Statement of Dependency of Parent(s)</i> . Note: There is no need to submit VA Form 21-686c when filing a claim for additional benefits for a dependent parent or parents.
- you are a veteran entitled to disability compensation, and - you are seeking additional benefits for a spouse who requires aid and attendance	VA Form 21-2680, <i>Examination for Housebound Status or Permanent Need for Regular Aid and Attendance</i> , or if your spouse resides in a nursing home, use VA Form 21-0779, <i>Request for Nursing Home Information in Connection with Claim for Aid and Attendance</i> . Note: Submit VA Form 21-686c in addition to one of the forms referenced above only if you have never received additional benefits for your spouse.
you are a veteran seeking additional benefits for a spouse based on common-law marriage	VA Form 21-4170, <i>Statement of Marital Relationship</i> , and VA Form 21P-4171, <i>Supporting Statement Regarding Marriage</i> . Note: The above referenced forms must be submitted in addition to VA Form 21-686c.

HOW TO APPLY ELECTRONICALLY

Want to apply electronically? You can apply online at www.va.gov. If you sign in or create an account at www.va.gov, we can prefill parts of your application and save your work in progress.

NOTE: You may wish to contact an accredited veteran service officer (VSO) to assist you with your application. You may locate a list of VSO's at <https://www.va.gov/vso/>.

WHERE TO SEND INFORMATION AND EVIDENCE

MAIL TO	SUBMIT ONLINE
Department of Veterans Affairs Evidence Intake Center PO Box 4444 Janesville, WI 53547-4444	VA gov: www.va.gov Direct Upload via access.va.gov

IMPORTANT: Applicant *must* provide his/her Social Security Number (SSN), *and* the SSN of his/her dependent(s) unless a SSN has not been assigned. Use Section IX, Item 25, Remarks, to explain why a SSN has not been assigned.

TO ADD A SPOUSE TO A VETERAN'S AWARD:

Marriage by Ceremony

VA will require additional evidence* to establish a spouse; if

- you do not reside within a state, territory, or other possession of the United States,
- your entries on the application conflict with other information you provided, and the discrepancies cannot be resolved through contact with you or a review of other information of record
- information of record raises questions regarding the validity of the marriage, or
- there is an indication of fraud or misrepresentation.

*Additional Evidence:

- Primary evidence of a marriage consists of a copy or abstract of the public record of a marriage, or a copy of the church record of a marriage, containing sufficient data to identify the
 - parties involved,
 - date (month, day, and year) and place (city and state, county and state, or city and country) of the marriage, and
 - number of prior marriages for each spouse, if not shown on the official record.
- If primary evidence of a marriage is unavailable, a marriage may still be established by submission of the following evidence in the order of preference shown below;
 - an official report from your branch of service regarding a marriage that occurred while you were in service,
 - an affidavit of the clergyman or magistrate who officiated in the marriage ceremony,
 - a certified copy of the original certificate of marriage,
 - affidavits or certified statements signed by two or more witnesses that attended the marriage ceremony, or
 - any other secondary evidence that reasonably supports the assertion that a valid marriage occurred.

Establishing a Common-Law Marriage

In some states it is possible to contract a marriage without a ceremony and without registration of the marriage. This type of marriage is referred to as a common-law marriage.

VA may recognize a common-law marriage that was considered valid in the state in which it took place. A common law marriage generally requires an agreement between the parties to be married, cohabitation, and holding themselves out to the public as married.

Evidence that must be submitted to claim a common-law marriage:

- VA Form 21-4170 completed by the veteran
- VA Form 21-4170 completed by the veteran's spouse in the common-law marriage
- Two VA Forms 21P-4171, each completed by two different persons that can provide their personal observations about the parties to the common-law marriage and the relationship that exists/existed between them, and
- Copies of the birth certificates of any children born of the common-law marriage.

Tribal Ceremony

VA may recognize marriages performed in accordance with tribal custom.

To establish a tribal marriage, a claimant must provide *all* of the following items:

- Affidavits from the parties married by tribal custom that include the name of the tribe, date (month, day, and year) of marriage, place (city and state, county and state, or city and country) where the marriage ceremony occurred, and name/ mailing address of the person who performed the ceremony.
- Affidavits from at least two people who were present at the time the tribal marriage ceremony took place. The affidavits must include the name of the tribe, date (month, day, and year) of marriage, place (city and state, county and state, or city and country) where the marriage ceremony occurred, and name/ mailing address of the person who performed the ceremony.
- Affidavit from the person who performed the ceremony, showing the date (month, day, and year) and place (city and state, county and state, or city and country) where the marriage ceremony occurred, and that person's authority for conducting the ceremony.

Proxy Marriage

A proxy marriage is a wedding in which one or both of the individuals being united are not physically present, and are instead represented by other persons. If both partners are absent, a double proxy wedding occurs.

Marriage by proxy typically occurs when a couple wishes to marry, but one or both partners cannot attend for reasons such as military service, imprisonment, or travel restrictions; or when a couple lives in a jurisdiction in which they cannot legally marry.

All documents/certificates issued in connection with a claimed proxy marriage must be provided to establish a proxy marriage for VA purposes.

Note: The validity of a proxy marriage is dependent upon the law in effect at the location in which the proxy marriage was performed.

Spousal Aid & Attendance (A&A)

- VA may pay additional benefits to a Veteran for a spouse with severe medical need/disability (ies). To claim the additional benefits, a
- Veteran must complete a VA Form 21-2680 and submit medical evidence showing his or her spouse
- is blind or so nearly blind as to have corrected visual acuity of 5/200 or less in both eyes or concentric contraction of the visual field to 5 degrees or less; or
- is a patient in a nursing home because of mental or physical incapacity (by completing VA Form 21-0779); or
- requires the aid of another person in order to perform personal functions required in everyday living, such as bathing, feeding, dressing, attending to the wants of nature, adjusting prosthetic devices, or protecting him or her from the hazards of his or her daily environment.

TO ADD A CHILD TO A BENEFICIARY/CLAIMANT'S AWARD:**Unmarried Child**

A person must be unmarried in order to be considered a child for VA purposes.

VA may continue paying additional benefits for an unmarried child

- until the child reaches age
 - 18, or
 - 23, if the child is attending an approved school, or
- indefinitely if the child becomes permanently incapable of self-support before his/her 18th birthday.

VA will require a copy of the child's birth certificate; if

- you do not reside within a state, territory or other possession of the United States,
- your entries on the application conflict with other information you provided, and the discrepancies cannot be resolved through contact with you or a review of other information of record, or
- there is an indication of fraud or misrepresentation.

School-Age Child

You **must complete and submit** VA Form 21-674 to claim additional benefits for a child who is

- between the ages of 18 and 23, and
- attending school.

Note:

- Claimants with more than one school-age child must complete a separate VA Form 21-674 for each child.
- VA Form 21-674 is used to report
 - school attendance,
 - a change in the educational facility a child is attending, and/or
 - a change in the date a school-age child plans to stop attending school.

Stepchild

VA will ask you to provide a copy of your stepchild's birth certificate, showing the names of both parents, before it will add the stepchild; if

- you do not reside within a state, territory, or other possession of the United States,
- your entries on the application conflict with other information you provided, and the discrepancies cannot be resolved through contact with you or a review of other information of record.

- information of record raises questions regarding the validity of the marriage of the stepchild's biological or adoptive parent to the veteran, or
- there is an indication of fraud or misrepresentation.

Provide a copy of the decree of adoption or adoptive placement agreement if the veteran's spouse is the adoptive parent of the stepchild.

Note:

- VA may pay benefits to or for a stepchild only if the stepchild is (or was at the time of the veteran's death, if the veteran is deceased) a member of the veteran's household.
- If the veteran and stepchild do not reside together (or were not residing together when the veteran died, if the veteran is deceased), the stepchild remains a member of the veteran's household *if*
 - he/she lives (or lived, if the veteran is deceased) apart for medical reasons, to attend school, or to fulfill a military service obligation, *or*
 - the veteran provides (or provided, if the veteran is deceased) at least half of the stepchild's support.

Adopted Child

A claim for additional benefits for an adopted child must include a copy of the

- final decree of adoption,
- adoptive placement agreement,
- interlocutory decree of adoptions, or
- revised birth certificate.

Note: VA *cannot* pay additional benefits for a grandchild or foster child unless the claimant submits evidence (referenced above) showing the veteran adopted the grand/foster child.

Child Permanently Incapable of Self-Support

VA may pay additional benefits for a child beyond his/her 23rd birthday if VA determines the child became permanently incapable of self-support before his/her 18th birthday.

A claim for additional benefits for a child who is permanently incapable of self-support must include

- medical evidence showing a permanent mental or physical disability existed before his/her 18th birthday, and
- a statement from an attending physician showing the nature and extent of the child's physical or mental impairment.

REMOVAL OF A SPOUSE FROM A VETERAN'S AWARD:

Divorce or Death of a Spouse

VA must remove a spouse from a veteran's award when the spouse dies or divorces/annuls the marriage to the veteran.

Note:

- Veterans in receipt of disability compensation are *not* required to report to VA a separation or estrangement from his/her spouse, as it will have no effect on his/her award.
- Veterans remain entitled to additional benefits for a stepchild after divorcing the stepchild's biological or adoptive parent, as long as the veteran provides at least half of the stepchild's support.

REMOVAL OF A CHILD FROM A BENEFICIARY'S AWARD:

Married Child
A person must be unmarried to qualify as a child for VA purposes. Therefore, a person of any age who marries ceases to be a child for VA purposes. Note: If a child marries, and then the marriage is terminated by annulment or declared void, VA may resume the payment of additional benefits for the child.
Child Who Is Between the Ages of 18 and 23 and Not Attending School
To be considered a school child for VA purposes a person must be between the ages of 18 and 23 and attending a VA-accredited educational facility.
Stepchild
VA must remove a stepchild from a veteran's award when the stepchild ceases being a member of the veteran's household. Note: The awarding of legal custody of a stepchild to someone other than the veteran will not affect the additional benefits to which the veteran is entitled for that child, as long as the stepchild remains a member of the veteran's household.
Child Given Up for Adoption
In most cases, a beneficiary who gives up a child for adoption is no longer entitled to additional benefits for that child. VA will use the most beneficial effective date when removing the veteran's child that has been given up for adoption. The date (month, day, and year) that the child was given up for adoption must be provided. Use Section IX, Item 25, Remarks to provide this information.
Death of a Child
VA must remove a child from a beneficiary's award when the child dies.

REMOVAL OF A DEPENDENT PARENT DUE TO DEATH:

Dependent Parent
VA must remove a dependent parent from a veteran's award when a parent dies.

For more information on VA benefits, visit our web site at www.va.gov, contact us at <https://www.va.gov/contact-us> or call us toll-free at 1-800-827-1000. If you use a Telecommunications Device for the Deaf (TDD), the Federal relay number is 711.

18A. NAME OF **THIRD** CHILD TO ADD (*First, Middle Initial, Last*)

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18B. SOCIAL SECURITY NUMBER

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18C. DATE OF BIRTH (MM-DD-YYYY)

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18D. PLACE OF BIRTH (Provide City and State, County and State, or City and Country)

City or County																		State/Province			Country		
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18E. IF THE CHILD DOES NOT LIVE WITH THE CLAIMANT PROVIDE NAME OF PERSON THE CHILD RESIDES WITH

18F. IF THE CHILD DOES NOT LIVE WITH THE CLAIMANT, PROVIDE COMPLETE PHYSICAL ADDRESS WHERE CHILD RESIDES

[illegible][illegible]

State/Province Country ZIP Code/Postal Code -

18G. CHILD STATUS (Check all that apply)

☐ BIOLOGICAL ☐ 18-23 YEARS OLD AND IN SCHOOL (If checked, fill out VA Form 21-674) ☐ ADOPTED ☐ CHILD PERMANENTLY INCAPABLE OF SELF-SUPPORT

☐ CHILD PREVIOUSLY MARRIED (If checked, provide the date marriage ended and how the marriage ended in Item 18H) ☐ STEPCCHILD (If checked, complete Item 18I)

18H. HOW AND WHEN MARRIAGE ENDED

DATE (MM-DD-YYYY) - -

☐ DIVORCE ☐ ANNULLED ☐ OTHER (Explain)

18I. IF YOU CHECKED "STEPCHILD" IN ITEM 18G, IS STEPCILD THE BIOLOGICAL CHILD OF YOUR SPOUSE?

☐ YES (If "Yes," provide the date the child entered veteran's household) DATE (MM-DD-YYYY) - -

☐ NO

19A. NAME OF **FOURTH** CHILD TO ADD (*First, Middle Initial, Last*)

19B. SOCIAL SECURITY NUMBER

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19C. DATE OF BIRTH (MM-DD-YYYY)

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19D. PLACE OF BIRTH (Provide City and State, County and State, or City and Country)

City or County																	State/Province			Country	
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19E. IF THE CHILD DOES NOT LIVE WITH THE CLAIMANT PROVIDE NAME OF PERSON THE CHILD RESIDES WITH

19F. IF THE CHILD DOES NOT LIVE WITH THE CLAIMANT, PROVIDE COMPLETE PHYSICAL ADDRESS WHERE CHILD RESIDES

[illegible][illegible]

State/Province			Country			ZIP Code/Postal Code						-				
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19G. CHILD STATUS (Check all that apply)

☐ BIOLOGICAL ☐ 18-23 YEARS OLD AND IN SCHOOL (If checked, fill out VA Form 21-674) ☐ ADOPTED ☐ CHILD PERMANENTLY INCAPABLE OF SELF-SUPPORT

☐ CHILD PREVIOUSLY MARRIED (If checked, provide the date marriage ended and how the marriage ended in Item 19H) ☐ STEPCHILD (If checked, complete Item 19I)

19H. HOW AND WHEN MARRIAGE ENDED

DATE (MM-DD-YYYY) - - ☐ DIVORCE ☐ ANNULLED ☐ OTHER (Explain)

19J. IF YOU CHECKED "STEPCHILD" IN ITEM 19G, IS STEPCHILD THE BIOLOGICAL CHILD OF YOUR SPOUSE?

☐ YES (If "Yes," provide the date the child entered veteran's household) DATE (MM-DD-YYYY) - -

☐ NO

VETERAN'S SOCIAL SECURITY NO.				—		—			
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NOTE: If marriage ended as an annulment or declared void, use Section IX, Item 25, "Remarks" to explain.

City or County																		State/Province		Country		
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21A. (1) DID YOU HAVE A STEPCHILD(REN) THAT WAS THE BIOLOGICAL OR ADOPTED CHILD(REN) OF THE FORMER SPOUSE LISTED IN ITEM 20A?

☐ NO (If "NO," skip to Section VI)

☐ NO (If "NO," complete Item 21F and then continue to Section VI)

[illegible][illegible][illegible]

State/Province Country ZIP Code/Postal Code -

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☐ More than half ☐ Half ☐ Less than half[illegible][illegible]

State/Province Country ZIP Code/Postal Code -

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☐ More than half ☐ Half ☐ Less than half

22A. (1) DEPENDENT TYPE (Check all that apply)

☐ SPOUSE ☐ MINOR CHILD (UNDER 18 YEARS OLD) ☐ STEPCHILD ☐ ADOPTED ☐ DEPENDENT PARENT

☐ CHILD PERMANENTLY INCAPABLE OF SELF-SUPPORT ☐ 18-23 YEARS OLD AND IN SCHOOL

22B. NAME OF DEPENDENT (First, Middle Initial, Last)

22C. DATE OF DEATH (MM/DD/YYYY)

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22D. PLACE OF DEATH (City & State, County & State, or City & Country)

City or County

[illegible]

State/Province

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Country

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22A. (2) DEPENDENT TYPE (Check all that apply)

☐ SPOUSE ☐ MINOR CHILD (UNDER 18 YEARS OLD) ☐ STEPCHILD ☐ ADOPTED ☐ DEPENDENT PARENT

☐ CHILD PERMANENTLY INCAPABLE OF SELF-SUPPORT ☐ 18-23 YEARS OLD AND IN SCHOOL

22B. NAME OF DEPENDENT (First, Middle Initial, Last)

22C. DATE OF DEATH (MM/DD/YYYY)

$$20 - 10 = 10$$

22D. PLACE OF DEATH (City & State, County & State, or City & Country)

City or County

[illegible]

State/Province

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Country

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23A. NAME OF CHILD (First, Middle Initial, Last)

23B. DATE OF MARRIAGE (MM-DD-YYYY)

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24A. NAME OF SCHOOLCHILD (First, Middle Initial, Last)

24B. DATE SCHOOLCHILD STOPPED ATTENDING SCHOOL (MM-DD-YYYY)

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25. REMARKS (If any)

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Additional Information

10B. Veteran/claimant's identification information > mailing address of veteran/claimant:
this is a really long apartment number

13B. Information needed to add spouse > living with spouse > address:
This is a very long apartment name and number

16B. Information needed to add child(ren) > child does not live with claimant > address Line 1:
This is a really long apartment number

21E2. Information needed for stepchild > living where > street Line 1:
this is a very long apartment number

21E2. Information needed for stepchild > living where > street Line 2:
this is a very long apartment number